WARNING CONCERNING COPYRIGHT RESTRICTIONS

THE COPYRIGHT LAW OF THE UNITED STATES (TITLE 17, UNITED STATES CODE) GOVERNS THE MAKING OF PHOTOCOPIES OR OTHER REPRODUCTIONS OF COPYRIGHT MATERIAL. UNDER CERTAIN CONDITIONS SPECIFIED IN THE LAW, LIBRARIES AND ARCHIVES ARE AUTHORIZED TO FURNISH A PHOTOCOPY OR OTHER REPRODUCTION. ONE OF THESE SPECIFIED CONDITIONS IS THAT THE PHOTOCOPY OR REPRODUCTION IS NOT TO BE "USED FOR ANY PURPOSE OTHER THAN PRIVATE STUDY, SCHOLARSHIP, OR RESEARCH". IF A USER MAKES A REQUEST FOR, OR LATER USES A PHOTOCOPY OR REPRODUCTION FOR PURPOSES IN EXCESS OF "FAIR USE", THAT USER MAY BE LIABLE FOR COPYRIGHT INFRINGEMENT. THIS INSTITUTION RESERVES THE RIGHT TO REFUSE AND ACCEPT A COPYING ORDER IF, IN ITS JUDGEMENT, FULFILLMENT OF THE ORDER WOULD INVOLVE VIOLATION OF COPYRIGHT LAW.

27 You will pray to him, and he will hear you,
and you will pay your vows.
28 You will decide on a matter, and it will be established for you,
and light will shine on your ways.
29 When others are humiliated, you say it is pride;
for he saves the humble.
30 He will deliver even those who are guilty;
they will escape because of the cleanness of your hands."[c]

23 Then Job answered:
2 "Today also my complaint is bitter;[d]
his[e] hand is heavy despite my groaning.
3 Oh, that I knew where I might find him,
that I might come even to his dwelling!
4 I would lay my case before him,
and fill my mouth with arguments.
5 I would learn what he would answer me,
and understand what he would say to me.
6 Would he contend with me in the greatness of his power?
No; but he would give heed to me.
7 There an upright person could reason with him,
and I should be acquitted forever by my judge.

8 "If I go forward, he is not there;
or backward, I cannot perceive him;
9 on the left he hides, and I cannot behold him;
I turn[f] to the right, but I cannot see him.
10 But he knows the way that I take;
when he has tested me, I shall come out like gold.
11 My foot has held fast to his steps;
I have kept his way and have not turned aside.
12 I have not departed from the commandment of his lips;
I have treasured in[g] my bosom the words of his mouth.
13 But he stands alone and who can dissuade him?
What he desires, that he does.
14 For he will complete what he appoints for me;
and many such things are in his mind.
15 Therefore I am terrified at his presence;
when I consider, I am in dread of him.
16 God has made my heart faint;
the Almighty[h] has terrified me;
17 If only I could vanish in darkness,
and thick darkness would cover my face![i]

24 "Why are times not kept by the Almighty,[h]
and why do those who know him never see his days?
2 The wicked[j] remove landmarks;
they seize flocks and pasture them.

c Meaning of Heb uncertain *d* Syr Vg Tg: Heb *rebellious* *e* Gk Syr: Heb *my*
f Syr Vg: Heb *he turns* *g* Gk Vg: Heb *from*
h Traditional rendering of Heb *Shaddai*
i Or *But I am not destroyed by the darkness; he has concealed the thick darkness from me*
j Gk: Heb *they*

3 They drive away the donl
the orphan;
they take the widow's c
pledge.
4 They thrust the needy off
road;
the poor of the earth all
themselves.
5 Like wild asses in the dese
they go out to their toil
scavenging in the wastela
food for their young.
6 They reap in a field not th
and they glean in the vi
of the wicked.
7 They lie all night naked, v
clothing,
and have no covering in
cold.
8 They are wet with the rai
mountains,
and cling to the rock fo
of shelter.

9 "There are those who snat
orphan child from t
breast,
and take as a pledge the
of the poor.
10 They go about naked, wit
clothing;
though hungry, they ca
sheaves;
11 between their terraces[k] the
out oil;
they tread the wine pres
suffer thirst.
12 From the city the dying gr
and the throat of the wc
cries for help;
yet God pays no attentic
their prayer.

13 "There are those who rebe
the light,

23.1–24.17: Reply of Job. 23.1–17: Another search for God's presence; now Job wants to *lay* his *case* before God, confident that *he would give heed* (in contrast to 9.32–34; 13.20–21). But he cannot find God, despite his own fidelity (vv. 11–12), and once more he experiences *dread*. **13:** *He stands alone,* literally, "he is in one," perhaps denoting divine sovereignty (see Deut 6.4).

24.1–17: Job accuses God of not having *times* for adjudication, and catalogues the sins of the wicked. Meanwhile, the *poor* suffer, but *God pays no attention to their prayer.*

24.18–25: Not only are there te
lems in these verses, but they are a
to interpret and seem out of chara
ken by Job, since they appear to
doctrine advocated by the frie
punishment for the wicked. The v

3 They drive away the donkey of the orphan;
they take the widow's ox for a pledge.
4 They thrust the needy off the road;
the poor of the earth all hide themselves.
5 Like wild asses in the desert
they go out to their toil,
scavenging in the wasteland food for their young.
6 They reap in a field not their own
and they glean in the vineyard of the wicked.
7 They lie all night naked, without clothing,
and have no covering in the cold.
8 They are wet with the rain of the mountains,
and cling to the rock for want of shelter.

9 "There are those who snatch the orphan child from the breast,
and take as a pledge the infant of the poor.
10 They go about naked, without clothing;
though hungry, they carry the sheaves;
11 between their terraces[k] they press out oil;
they tread the wine presses, but suffer thirst.
12 From the city the dying groan,
and the throat of the wounded cries for help;
yet God pays no attention to their prayer.

13 "There are those who rebel against the light,
who are not acquainted with its ways,
and do not stay in its paths.
14 The murderer rises at dusk
to kill the poor and needy,
and in the night is like a thief.
15 The eye of the adulterer also waits for the twilight,
saying, 'No eye will see me';
and he disguises his face.
16 In the dark they dig through houses;
by day they shut themselves up;
they do not know the light.
17 For deep darkness is morning to all of them;
for they are friends with the terrors of deep darkness.

18 "Swift are they on the face of the waters;
their portion in the land is cursed;
no treader turns toward their vineyards.
19 Drought and heat snatch away the snow waters;
so does Sheol those who have sinned.
20 The womb forgets them;
the worm finds them sweet;
they are no longer remembered;
so wickedness is broken like a tree.

21 "They harm[l] the childless woman,
and do no good to the widow.
22 Yet God[m] prolongs the life of the mighty by his power;
they rise up when they despair of life.

k Meaning of Heb uncertain *l* Gk Tg: Heb *feed on* or *associate with* *m* Heb *he*

24.18–25: Not only are there textual problems in these verses, but they are also difficult to interpret and seem out of character if spoken by Job, since they appear to affirm the doctrine advocated by the friends: divine punishment for the wicked. The various solutions proposed, however (to attribute them to Bildad, or to Zophar, or to add "you say" in v. 18, as in the RSV), remain quite hypothetical. The wicked seem to be described in vv. 18–21; God's justice may be delayed (vv. 22–23), but it never fails (vv. 24–25).

23 He gives them security, and they are supported;
his eyes are upon their ways.
24 They are exalted a little while, and then are gone;
they wither and fade like the mallow;[n]
they are cut off like the heads of grain.
25 If it is not so, who will prove me a liar,
and show that there is nothing in what I say?"

25 Then Bildad the Shuhite answered:
2 "Dominion and fear are with God;[o]
he makes peace in his high heaven.
3 Is there any number to his armies?
Upon whom does his light not arise?
4 How then can a mortal be righteous before God?
How can one born of woman be pure?
5 If even the moon is not bright
and the stars are not pure in his sight,
6 how much less a mortal, who is a maggot,
and a human being, who is a worm!"

26 Then Job answered:
2 "How you have helped one who has no power!
How you have assisted the arm that has no strength!
3 How you have counseled one who has no wisdom,
and given much good advice!
4 With whose help have you uttered words,
and whose spirit has come forth from you?
5 The shades below tremble,
the waters and their inhabitants.
6 Sheol is naked before God,
and Abaddon has no covering.
7 He stretches out Zaphon[p] over the void,
and hangs the earth upon nothing.
8 He binds up the waters in his thick clouds,
and the cloud is not torn open by them.
9 He covers the face of the full moon,

n Gk: Heb *like all others*
o Heb *him*
p Or *the North*

25.1–6: Third discourse of Bildad. This is a suspiciously short speech, and some join it with 26.5–14 in order to fill out the usual pattern of complete speeches. There is no textual warrant for this. The theme is the uncleanness and abasement of mortals, which had already been developed by Eliphaz (4.17–21; 15.14–16) and Zophar (11.5–12); Job also subscribed to this (9.2–12; 12.9–25; 14.4), without using it for self-accusation.

26.1–14: Reply of Job. 2–4: Job's reply to Bildad is harsh and sarcastic. He leaves unnamed the *spirit* that *has come forth from* Bildad, but the implication is that it is evil or unworthy. **5–14:** A hymn about divine omnipotence. While such a theme is not impossible in the mouth of Job, it has been ignored by him in the third round of the discussion, to be replaced by the theme of divine indifference. Neither is it directly related to the immediate context (vv. 2–4 and 27.2). Hence some attribute the poem to Bildad, but without textual evidence. **5–6:** The *shades* are those who inhabit the *waters* that are found in *Sheol/Abaddon*. They are not beyond the divine reach (12.22; Ps 139.8; Prov 15.11; see also Am 9.2), but they enjoy no loving contact with God (Ps 6.5).

26.7: *Zaphon* means "north," and is usually associated with the dwelling of the gods according to Canaanite mythology. The mountain of their assembly (see Isa 14.13) is comparable to the Greek Mt. Olympus; here, however, it is said to be stretched out (like a tent?) *over the void* (Hebrew "tōhū," mentioned in Gen 1.2). This picture differs from the usual description, according to which the earth is built on pillars (9.6) that seem to be fixed in the abyss; here the earth *hangs upon nothing*. **8:** Despite the weight of the *waters, the cloud is not torn open by them*. **9:** God has his own *cloud*, which covers *the face of the full moon*

and spreads over
10 He has described a
face of the w
at the boundary b
and darkness
11 The pillars of heave
and are astoundec
12 By his power he sti
by his understand
down Rahab.
13 By his wind the hea
made fair;
his hand pierced t
serpent.
14 These are indeed bu
of his ways;
and how small a
hear of him!
But the thunder c
who can und

27 Job again took
and said:
2 "As God lives, who
away my rigl
and the Almighty
made my sou
3 as long as my breatl
and the spirit of C
nostrils,
4 my lips will not spe
and my tongue w
deceit.

(or perhaps his throne?).
from being seen, and it is r
looked for him in vain (cl
is the God-given limit to
on the horizon, which is *t*
light and darkness.
26.11: The *pillars of heaven* a
firmament or sky, and per
mountains on the horizon
cause of the divine *rebuke*
scribed in v. 12. *Sea* is per
where it is paired with Le
with *Rahab* (see 9.13 n.). T
of chaos (38.8–11). **13:** The
conflict with chaos contin
of piercing *the fleeing serpe*
with Leviathan in Isa 27.1.
ways is perhaps the outline
for the cosmos, and mort
whisper of *the thunder of h*
37.2, 4).

days of affliction come to meet me.
28 I go about in sunless gloom;
I stand up in the assembly and cry for help.
29 I am a brother of jackals,
and a companion of ostriches.
30 My skin turns black and falls from me,
and my bones burn with heat.
31 My lyre is turned to mourning,
and my pipe to the voice of those who weep.

31 "I have made a covenant with my eyes;
how then could I look upon a virgin?
2 What would be my portion from God above,
and my heritage from the Almighty[j] on high?
3 Does not calamity befall the unrighteous,
and disaster the workers of iniquity?
4 Does he not see my ways,
and number all my steps?

5 "If I have walked with falsehood,
and my foot has hurried to deceit—
6 let me be weighed in a just balance,
and let God know my integrity!—
7 if my step has turned aside from the way,
and my heart has followed my eyes,
and if any spot has clung to my hands;
8 then let me sow, and another eat;
and let what grows for me be rooted out.

9 "If my heart has been enticed by a woman,
and I have lain in wait at my neighbor's door;
10 then let my wife grind for another,
and let other men kneel over her.
11 For that would be a heinous crime;
that would be a criminal offense;
12 for that would be a fire consuming down to Abaddon,
and it would burn to the root all my harvest.

13 "If I have rejected the cause of my male or female slaves,
when they brought a complaint against me;
14 what then shall I do when God rises up?
When he makes inquiry, what shall I answer him?
15 Did not he who made me in the womb make them?
And did not one fashion us in the womb?

16 "If I have withheld anything that the poor desired,
or have caused the eyes of the widow to fail,
17 or have eaten my morsel alone,
and the orphan has not eaten from it—
18 for from my youth I reared the orphan[k] like a father,
and from my mother's womb I guided the widow[l]—

j Traditional rendering of Heb *Shaddai*
k Heb *him* *l* Heb *her*

19 if I have seen anyon
lack of clothi
or a poor person
covering,
20 whose loins have no
and who was not
the fleece of
21 if I have raised my h
the orphan,
because I saw I ha
at the gate;
22 then let my shoulder
from my sho
and let my arm be
its socket.
23 For I was in terror o
from God,
and I could not ha
majesty.

24 "If I have made gold
or called fine gold
confidence;
25 if I have rejoiced bec
wealth was gr
or because my han
much;
26 if I have looked at th
it shone,
or the moon movi
splendor,
27 and my heart has bee
enticed,
and my mouth has
hand;
28 this also would be an
be punished b
for I should have b
God above.

29 "If I have rejoiced at
those who hat
or exulted when ev
them—
30 I have not let my mo
by asking for their
curse—
31 if those of my tent ev

31.1–40: A negative confession, consisting of a series of oaths calling down a curse if one has acted wrongly. **5:** *If* begins the customary form of the oath, to which the consequence is usually, but not always, added: If I have done so and so, then let so and so happen to me. The exact number of oaths Job takes is not easy to determine (between nine and sixteen). He mentions lust, dishonesty, adultery, treatment of slaves, mistreatment of the poor, avarice, idolatry (v. 27 may refer to throwing kisses with the *hand*), revenge, failure of hospitality, hypocrisy, and mistreatment of the land.

31.35: With considerable
fers his *signature*, literally hi
letter of the Hebrew alpha
shaped like a cross, meaning

19 if I have seen anyone perish for
lack of clothing,
or a poor person without
covering,
20 whose loins have not blessed me,
and who was not warmed with
the fleece of my sheep;
21 if I have raised my hand against
the orphan,
because I saw I had supporters
at the gate;
22 then let my shoulder blade fall
from my shoulder,
and let my arm be broken from
its socket.
23 For I was in terror of calamity
from God,
and I could not have faced his
majesty.

24 "If I have made gold my trust,
or called fine gold my
confidence;
25 if I have rejoiced because my
wealth was great,
or because my hand had gotten
much;
26 if I have looked at the sun[m] when
it shone,
or the moon moving in
splendor,
27 and my heart has been secretly
enticed,
and my mouth has kissed my
hand;
28 this also would be an iniquity to
be punished by the judges,
for I should have been false to
God above.

29 "If I have rejoiced at the ruin of
those who hated me,
or exulted when evil overtook
them—
30 I have not let my mouth sin
by asking for their lives with a
curse—
31 if those of my tent ever said,
'O that we might be sated with
his flesh!'[n]—
32 the stranger has not lodged in the
street;
I have opened my doors to the
traveler—
33 if I have concealed my
transgressions as others
do,[o]
by hiding my iniquity in my
bosom,
34 because I stood in great fear of the
multitude,
and the contempt of families
terrified me,
so that I kept silence, and did
not go out of doors—
35 Oh, that I had one to hear me!
(Here is my signature! let the
Almighty[p] answer me!)
Oh, that I had the indictment
written by my adversary!
36 Surely I would carry it on my
shoulder;
I would bind it on me like a
crown;
37 I would give him an account of all
my steps;
like a prince I would approach
him.

38 "If my land has cried out against
me,
and its furrows have wept
together;
39 if I have eaten its yield without
payment,
and caused the death of its
owners;
40 let thorns grow instead of wheat,
and foul weeds instead of
barley."

The words of Job are ended.

m Heb *the light* *n* Meaning of Heb uncertain *o* Or *as Adamdid* *p* Traditional rendering of Heb *Shaddai*

31.35: With considerable bravado Job offers his *signature,* literally his "taw," the last letter of the Hebrew alphabet, which was shaped like a cross, meaning "mark," or signature. Any *indictment* of him would be merely a badge of honor, since he can give full *account* of his life.

24 Therefore mortals fear him;
he does not regard any who are
wise in their own conceit."

38 Then the LORD answered Job out
of the whirlwind:
2 "Who is this that darkens counsel
by words without
knowledge?
3 Gird up your loins like a man,
I will question you, and you
shall declare to me.

4 "Where were you when I laid the
foundation of the earth?
Tell me, if you have
understanding.
5 Who determined its
measurements—surely you
know!
Or who stretched the line upon
it?
6 On what were its bases sunk,
or who laid its cornerstone
7 when the morning stars sang
together
and all the heavenly beings[l]
shouted for joy?

8 "Or who shut in the sea with
doors
when it burst out from the
womb?—
9 when I made the clouds its
garment,
and thick darkness its swaddling
band,
10 and prescribed bounds for it,
and set bars and doors,
11 and said, 'Thus far shall you
come, and no farther,
and here shall your proud waves
be stopped'?

12 "Have you commanded the
morning since your days
began,
and caused the dawn to know
its place,
13 so that it might take hold of the
skirts of the earth,
and the wicked be shaken out of
it?
14 It is changed like clay under the
seal,
and it is dyed[m] like a garment.
15 Light is withheld from the
wicked,
and their uplifted arm is broken.

16 "Have you entered into the
springs of the sea,
or walked in the recesses of the
deep?
17 Have the gates of death been
revealed to you,
or have you seen the gates of
deep darkness?
18 Have you comprehended the
expanse of the earth?
Declare, if you know all this.

19 "Where is the way to the dwelling
of light,

l Heb *sons of God* *m* Cn: Heb *and they stand forth*

38.1–42.6: The voice from the whirlwind. There are two remarkable speeches of the LORD, and two replies from Job.

38.1–40.2: First speech of the LORD. **38.1**: *The whirlwind,* a frequent setting of theophanies, i.e. divine appearances (Nah 1.3; Zech 9.14; Ps 18.7–15; 50.3; Ezek 1.4; Hab ch 3). **2–3**: Throughout, Job has asked why misfortune happened (e.g. 2.11, 16, 20; 13.24). The LORD now offers him the right to challenge the divine rule, but first he has questions to put to Job. These questions seem irrelevant and unexpected, yet playful (only 38.21 displays sharp irony). Their apparent purpose is to lead Job into the mystery of God's creation, of which Job and his suffering form only one part. The questions range through the whole of creation: *earth* (vv. 4–7); *sea* (vv. 8–11); *dawn* (vv. 12–15); Sheol (*the deep, death,* vv. 16–18); *light* and *darkness* (vv. 19–21); weather phenomena (vv. 22–30); the constellations (vv. 31–33); *clouds* and *water* (vv. 34–38); the providential care of the animal world (from *lion* to *eagle,* 38.39–39.40). **7**: *Heavenly beings,* see 1.6 n.; here they are associated with the *morning stars* on the festive occasion of the creative actions. **8**: *Sea,* see 3.8 n.

and where is the place of
darkness,
20 that you may take it to its
territory
and that you may discern the
paths to its home?
21 Surely you know, for you were
born then,
and the number of your days is
great!

22 "Have you entered the storehouses
of the snow,
or have you seen the
storehouses of the hail,
23 which I have reserved for the time
of trouble,
for the day of battle and war?
24 What is the way to the place
where the light is
distributed,
or where the east wind is
scattered upon the earth?

25 "Who has cut a channel for the
torrents of rain,
and a way for the thunderbolt,
26 to bring rain on a land where no
one lives,
on the desert, which is empty of
human life,
27 to satisfy the waste and desolate
land,
and to make the ground put
forth grass?

28 "Has the rain a father,
or who has begotten the drops
of dew?
29 From whose womb did the ice
come forth,
and who has given birth to the
hoarfrost of heaven?
30 The waters become hard like
stone,
and the face of the deep is
frozen.

31 "Can you bind the chains of the
Pleiades,
or loose the cords of Orion?
32 Can you lead forth the Mazzaroth
in their season,
or can you guide the Bear with
its children?
33 Do you know the ordinances of
the heavens?
Can you establish their rule on
the earth?

34 "Can you lift up your voice to the
clouds,
so that a flood of waters may
cover you?
35 Can you send forth lightnings, so
that they may go
and say to you, 'Here we are'?
36 Who has put wisdom in the
inward parts,[n]
or given understanding to the
mind?[n]
37 Who has the wisdom to number
the clouds?
Or who can tilt the waterskins
of the heavens,
38 when the dust runs into a mass
and the clods cling together?

39 "Can you hunt the prey for the
lion,
or satisfy the appetite of the
young lions,
40 when they crouch in their dens,
or lie in wait in their covert?
41 Who provides for the raven its
prey,
when its young ones cry to
God,
and wander about for lack of
food?

n Meaning of Heb uncertain

39 "Do you know w
mountain goat
Do you observe the
the deer?
2 Can you number the
they fulfill,
and do you know t
when they give
3 when they crouch to
their offspring,
and are delivered of
young?
4 Their young ones bec
they grow up i
they go forth, and
to them.

5 "Who has let the wild
Who has loosed the
the swift ass,
6 to which I have given
for its home,
the salt land for its
place?
7 It scorns the tumult o
it does not hear the
the driver.
8 It ranges the mountai
pasture,
and it searches after
thing.

9 "Is the wild ox willin
you?
Will it spend the ni
crib?
10 Can you tie it in the f
ropes,
or will it harrow th
after you?
11 Will you depend on it
strength is grea
and will you hand
labor to it?
12 Do you have faith in
return,
and bring your grai
threshing floor

13 "The ostrich's wings
though its pinions l
plumage.[p]
14 For it leaves its eggs t

38.21: A truly sarcastic jibe; Job would have had to have been *born* before the creation, like Wisdom in Prov 8.22ff. **26**: Astonishingly, *rain* falls *on a land where no one lives;* such puzzling prodigality!

38.32: The determination of these stars is uncertain.

39.13–18: The text is uncertain; perhaps the *ostrich,* lacking *wisdom* (v. 17), is a point made against Job.